

ET

AIRMAIL



Change
Agent





HOW DOES CHANGE FEEL TO YOU?

We all feel differently about change. Take a moment to reflect on how change feels to you.

- *Do you think change is positive or negative? In between? Why?*
 - *Does it make you feel scared, or do you see it as an opportunity?*
 - *Does it depend on the type or amount of change?*
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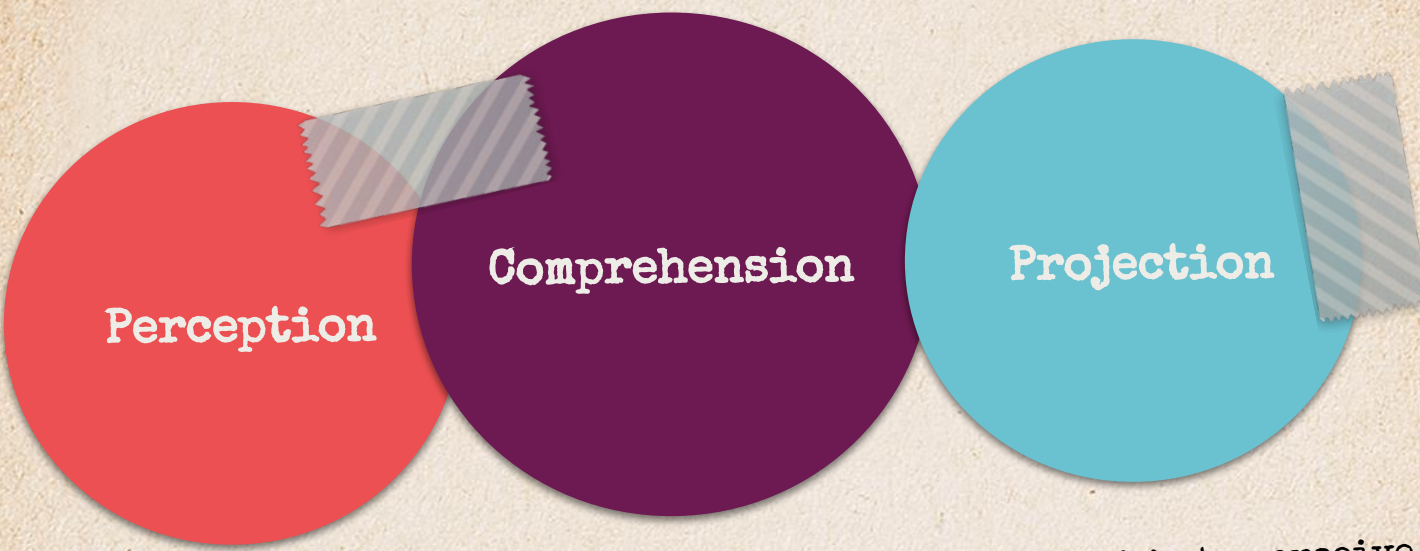


IDENTIFY YOUR CHANGE

What change (past, present, or future) do you want to focus on in this course? Note down the details here so you can refer back to it as you work through the strategies to follow.



SITUATIONAL AWARENESS (SA)



Perception

Comprehension

Projection

Perception (Level 1 SA): The first step in achieving SA is to perceive the status, attributes, and dynamics of relevant elements in the environment. Thus, Level 1 SA, the most basic level of SA, involves the processes of monitoring, cue detection, and simple recognition, which lead to an awareness of multiple situational elements (objects, events, people, systems, environmental factors) and their current states (locations, conditions, modes, actions).

Comprehension (Level 2 SA): The next step in SA formation involves a synthesis of disjointed Level 1 SA elements through the processes of pattern recognition, interpretation, and evaluation. Level 2 SA requires integrating this information to understand how it will impact upon the individual's goals and objectives. This includes building a comprehensive picture of the world, or of that portion of the world of concern to the individual.

Projection (Level 3 SA): The third and highest level of SA involves the ability to project the future actions of the elements in the environment. Level 3 SA is achieved through knowledge of the status and dynamics of the elements and comprehension of the situation (Levels 1 and 2 SA), and then extrapolating this information forward in time to determine how it will affect future states of the operational environment.

PROJECTION

Role
Changes

Product
Changes

Processes
& Systems

Employees
Leaving/
Joining

Leadership

Org
Structures



5 STAGES OF CHANGE

The stages, popularly known by the acronym DABDA, include:

1. **Denial** - The first reaction is denial. In this stage, individuals believe the information is somehow mistaken, and cling to a false, preferable reality.
2. **Anger** - When the individual recognizes that denial cannot continue, they become frustrated. Certain psychological responses of a person undergoing this phase would be: "Why me? It's not fair!"; "How can this happen to me?"; "Who is to blame?"; "Why would this happen?"
3. **Bargaining** - The third stage involves the hope that the individual can avoid a cause of grief or dissatisfaction. People can bargain or seek compromise.
4. **Depression** - "Everything changes so often, why even bother?"; "It's not like I have any control anyway."
5. **Acceptance** - "It's going to be okay."; "I can't fight it; I may as well accept it."

Adapted from the Kübler-Ross model





REFLECT ON YOUR STAGES OF CHANGE

While we've covered common emotional reactions to change, not everyone experiences change the same way. Reflect on your emotional reaction to your change. Did you go through all 5 Stages? Did you skip some of the stages or go through a different order? Did you feel something entirely different?

Use the space on this page and the next to identify which stages you experienced with your change, and note down any other emotions you're currently feeling (or felt).

Denial:

Anger:

Bargaining:

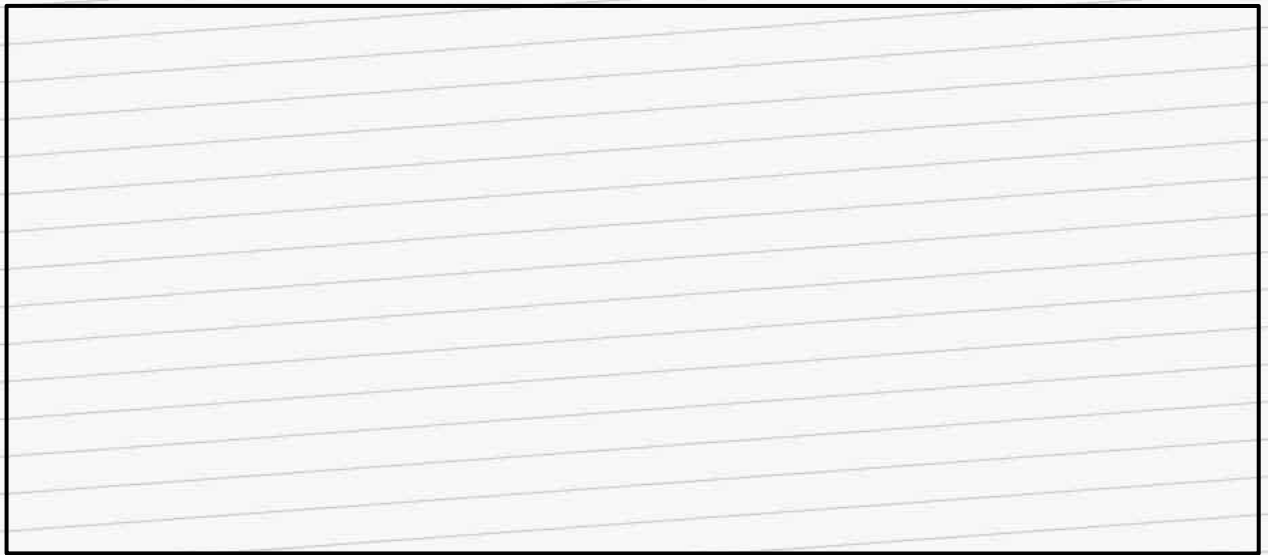
Depression:

Acceptance:



REFLECT ON YOUR STAGES OF CHANGE

What other emotions have you experienced with this change?



What is your current emotional state around your change? Is this what you want to be feeling? If not, what needs to happen to get you to your desired emotional state?





FINDING OPTIONS

Five Options

This method is exactly what it sounds like - brainstorm five options to try. This helps you come up with additional strategies that you may not think of right off the bat. It forces you to not simply rely on your first idea. Oftentimes, that 5th option will be the most creative and different, so using this technique will help you uncover new possibilities. But, your first idea could be your best too!

Obstacle Approach

Use this method to brainstorm all the things that could trip you up, or get in the way of a successful outcome. By thinking all of these obstacles through, you are able to anticipate and solve for issues before they even happen.

Ideal Future Technique

Imagine what could happen, in an ideal future. Imagine if nothing got in your way, and everything worked out perfectly, and you could have exactly what you wanted. Sometimes this is referred to as the blue sky technique, because there are no storm clouds coming your way! This technique allows you to remove self-imposed limits about what can or could be.

Reverse Brainstorming

Reverse brainstorming is a technique where we focus on how to achieve an opposite result of what is expected. This allows us to think differently about our goals. What behaviors would send us in the opposite direction from what we intended? What risks have we missed? By using this technique, you may uncover new ways to think about your actual goal.



WHAT ARE YOUR OPTIONS?

Using one or more of these techniques, brainstorm options for solving a problem related to your change.

Five
Options



Obstacle
Approach



Ideal
Future
Technique



Reverse
Brain-
storming





REFRAMING PERSPECTIVES

When confronted with a situation we perceive as negative, use the following process to help you reframe your circumstances, thereby putting yourself in a more resourceful, empowering and helpful frame-of-mind.

Step 1: Identify the Problem

- What challenge am I facing?
- What unhelpful behavior am I indulging in?
- What limiting **state** of mind am I experiencing?

Step 2: Challenge Your Assumption

- What is valuable and useful about this assumption I am making?
- What is useful about how I'm currently framing things?
- What is unhelpful about the assumption I am making?
- What is unhelpful about the way I'm framing things?
- Is there any evidence that goes against this assumption?
- Am I using any rules that could be challenged?
- How else could I interpret this experience?
- What else could this possibly mean? How could that be helpful?

Step 3: Reframe Your Circumstances

Is this really a problem, or is it a problem because of the way I feel about this situation?

- How would I deal with this situation if I were a scientist? Lawyer? Child? Man? Woman? Harry Potter?
- What would someone I admire do in this situation?
- What if this problem was part of a cartoon? How would the cartoon characters solve this problem?

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- How would I approach this situation if I only had a day to solve it? How about an hour? How about a minute?
 - What is the opposite to this problem? How is this of value?
 - What would other people do in my situation to help resolve this problem?
 - What advice would I give someone else who is experiencing this problem?
 - What would I do right now if I knew I couldn't fail?
 - What if I knew what to do right now? What would I do? What's the best way to accomplish this?

Step 4: Test the Reframe

Now, have a think about your new behavior/approach/perspective and complete the following statements:

- [new perspective] allows me (or the business) to...
- [new perspective] provides me (or the business)...
- [new perspective] helps me (or the business) to...



REFRAME YOUR PERSPECTIVES

Think about a situation where you'd like to reframe your perspective. Using the questions on pages 11-12, walk through the Reframing Perspectives process to try and think about this situation differently.

Step 1: Identify the Problem

Step 2: Challenge Your Assumption

Step 3: Reframe Your Circumstances

Step 4: Test the Reframe



MAKING DECISIONS UNDER UNCERTAINTY

1. Day One Hypothesis

As soon as you know that you need to solve a problem, make an early hypothesis about what the solution is. With what you know now, how can you find a solution? Use this initial idea to get started, but also be open to building onto the plan as you start working and gather more information. This technique is helpful when you don't know how long you have to make a decision. If it turns out it needs to be made on Day 2, at least you've already determined something and can start moving forward.

2. Directionally Right, Same Order of Magnitude.

Without having all the information, you'll never get to an exact, perfect decision. Instead, you can strive to make your choice directionally right. If your aim is to increase your number of subscribers, how can you start moving in that direction even if the details are unclear? You should also be close by orders of magnitude. For example, you could increase your number of subscribers by 1000, but if your overall goal is one million, you're not in the same order of magnitude. Try to make a decision you believe will get you near your goal, even if it can't get you all the way. This is by no means an invitation to underperform. You should always strive for your original goal, but recognize that you need to get started somehow before you can get there.

3. What Do You Have to Believe?

If a deciding factor is unclear or unknown, how can you use the information you have about the current state of things to make a realistic prediction for the future? When you fill in the unknown variable with this predicted value, does your decision have a reasonable chance of actually working out? If so, you can start with that and see where it takes you. This technique helps push through indecision paralysis so that you can quickly make a decision without overanalyzing or worrying that you don't have everything you need to make the "right" one.

Adapted from: inc.com/adam-vaccaro/how-to-make-a-snap-decision.html



DECIDE WHAT'S NEXT

Use one of the decision-making strategies discussed to figure out a way to move forward on something that's blocking you.

1. What part of your change is presenting a problem you need to solve? Describe what you need to decide.

2. Which technique described in the course do you want to use?
See p. 14 for a recap.

3. Using that technique, brainstorm your ideas for moving forward here.



4 QUESTIONS TO LEAD/ ASK IN CHANGE

1. Why do we need to change, and why now? What are the imperatives driving this change? Why is the previous strategy no longer good enough? Where on the Profit & Loss are we feeling, or anticipating, pain? Are you sure you want X to change, even if it means you can't have Y anymore?
2. What is the full extent of the change we need? Don't underestimate the extent of the change you need, either privately or publicly. However tempting it is to tell people that this is just an incremental change — when it is nothing of the sort — or however politically expedient it seems to underplay the extent of the change required, a lack of clarity about the extent of the change required will make subsequent conversations about resources and priorities much harder.
3. If we figure out 1 and 2, what should improve as a result? How will we measure the improvement we've been targeting?

And perhaps most overlooked of all:

4. How does this new strategy or change link to previous strategies? Answering this question is critical if leaders are to reduce the confusion that a cumulative overload of strategic or change initiatives — another year, another “strategy” — and their potentially conflicting targets can cause. If leaders can't explain these links clearly, then you need to revisit the need for this change (Questions 1-3) or phase out some of the existing initiatives.

hbr.org/2017/06/how-to-communicate-clearly-during-organizational-change



COMMUNICATE WHAT YOU NEED

We talked about 4 Questions to Lead/Ask in Change, but what else might you need to know? Think about your change as you answer the following questions.

If you're EXPERIENCING a change, what else might still be unclear for you after asking these 4 questions? What specific job-related issues might you need to clarify? Write down your additional questions here.



If you're LEADING a change, what other questions do you anticipate employees will ask, after answering these 4 questions? What job-specific functions will this change affect? Write down your additional questions here.

Once you identify what additional information might help clarify the change, take the next step of asking for or delivering that information.

YOUR CHANGECRAFT TOOLBOX

1. Be ready for anything.

Changecraft: Situational Awareness (p. 4-5)

- Perception, Comprehension, Projection

Changecraft: The 5 Stages of Change (p. 6)

- Denial, Anger, Bargaining, Depression, Acceptance

2. Think outside the box.

Changecraft: Finding Options (p. 9)

- Five Options
- Obstacle Approach
- Ideal Future
- Reverse Brainstorming

3. Use resources wisely.

Changecraft: Reframing Perspectives (p. 11-12)

- Step 1: Identify the problem.
- Step 2: Challenge your assumption.
- Step 3: Reframe your circumstances.
- Step 4: Test the reframe.

4. Tolerate ambiguity.

Changecraft: Making Decisions Under Uncertainty (p. 14)

- Day One Hypothesis
- Directionally Right, Same Order of Magnitude
- What do you have to believe?

5. Communicate.

Changecraft: 4 Questions to Lead/Ask in Change (p. 16)

- What do we need to change and why now?
- What is the full extent of the change?
- What should improve as a result of this change? How will we measure that?
- How does this new strategy or change link to previous strategies?



YOUR BIGGEST TAKEAWAY

What was your biggest takeaway from this workshop? Which strategy will you use when you encounter change in your life?

